

Boys' Loop Opening Scheduled

Boys' Baseball of El Paso Inc. will hold its opening ceremonies at 6:45 p.m. Friday at Memorial Softball Park on Cobia.

Larry Welsch, commissioner of the league this year, said the reason for the switch to Memorial Park was to accommodate the more than 1,500 youthful baseball players expected to be on hand.

The players from the 96 minor and major league teams for boys 8 through 12 years of age will assemble at the park at 6 p.m. for team pictures with four teams remaining to play in exhibition games.

Gene Stogner of the El Paso Parks and Recreation Department will be the master of ceremonies for the night and will introduce past commissioners and board of directors in attendance.

Also on hand will be Mayor Peter de Wetter, who will address the crowd, and Sal Berroteran, Parks and Recreation alderman.

The 424th Army Band under the direction of WO James Choate, will play the national anthem and a local Boy Scouts group will present the colors.

Rev. Frank Grubbs of St. Alban's Episcopal Church, will give the invocation.

Andy Cohen, former big league baseball player, manager and coach, will relate some of his experiences in baseball as the featured speaker.

In the first exhibition game of the night Skyline Lions Club of the Mountain Minor League will meet Martin Funeral Home of Northeast Minor League in a three-inning game.

The second exhibition game will pit Bonded Realty of Mountain Major League against B&B Auto Salvage of the Highland Major League in a four-inning battle.

—The El Paso Umpires Association, umpires during the season for Boys' Baseball, will provide six umpires for each game.

Donn Clendenon of the Montreal Expos struck out 163 times with the Pittsburgh Pirates in 1968. It was the top figure in the National League.